

\* **CLAUDE**

AI Assistant for Software Development

# How to Use Claude to Query Your GitHub Repository

A step-by-step guide to connecting a repo and asking Claude questions about your code

## WHAT THIS GUIDE COVERS

- 1 Opening the GitHub sync option inside a Claude chat
- 2 Selecting the repository and branch to link
- 3 Adding the repository so Claude can read it
- 4 Starting a new chat against the linked repository

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### AUDIENCE

Team members using Claude on claude.ai

### PLATFORM

claude.ai — GitHub integration

Version 1.0

Guide

## Introduction

Claude can connect directly to a GitHub repository, read its files, and answer questions about the codebase in plain conversation. This is useful for quickly understanding an unfamiliar repo, tracing how a feature works, checking for bugs, or getting a summary of recent changes — without leaving the chat window.

This guide walks through the four steps needed to link a repository to a Claude chat and begin asking questions about it, using the **eyreen/dl-rainfall-data-imputation-pred-system** repository as a worked example.

Before you start, you will need:

- A Claude.ai account with GitHub sync enabled
- A GitHub account connected to Claude, with access to the target repository
- The repository already exists on GitHub (public or private, as long as access is granted)

## Step-by-Step Instructions

### 1 Open the GitHub sync prompt

When you start or return to a chat, Claude may show a prompt inviting you to work with your GitHub repositories. Click **“Continue to GitHub sync”** to link a repository to the current chat. (The panel also offers **“Try Claude Code”** for deeper, agentic work across a full codebase — useful if you later need Claude to edit and run code, not just answer questions about it.)

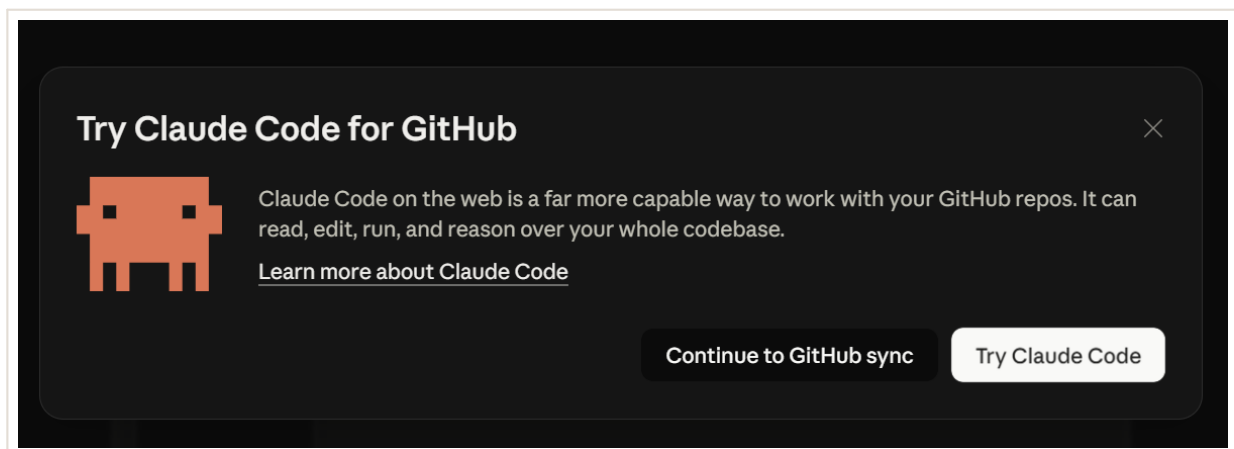


Figure 1 — The “Try Claude Code for GitHub” prompt, with the “Continue to GitHub sync” option highlighted.

**Tip** — If this prompt doesn’t appear automatically, look for the GitHub icon or the attachment (+) menu near the message box to open the same panel manually.

### 2 Select the repository

In the **“Add content from GitHub”** panel, click the **“Select a repository”** dropdown. Start typing the repository name to filter the list, then choose the correct one — in this example, **eyreen / dl-rainfall-data-imputation-pred-system**.

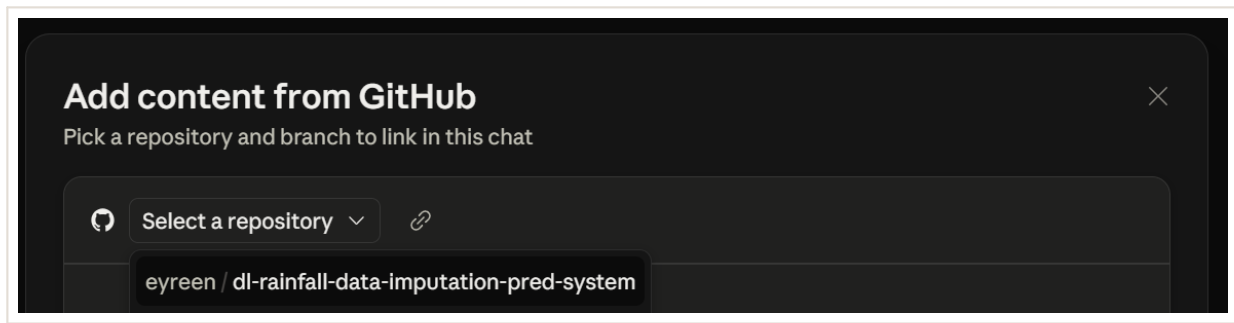


Figure 2 — Choosing a repository from the dropdown list.

**Tip** — Only repositories your connected GitHub account has access to will appear here. If a repo is missing, check its access permissions on GitHub first.

### 3 Add the repository to the chat

Once the repository is selected, its name appears in the field along with a branch/link icon. Click **“Add repository”** on the right to confirm and attach it to the conversation.

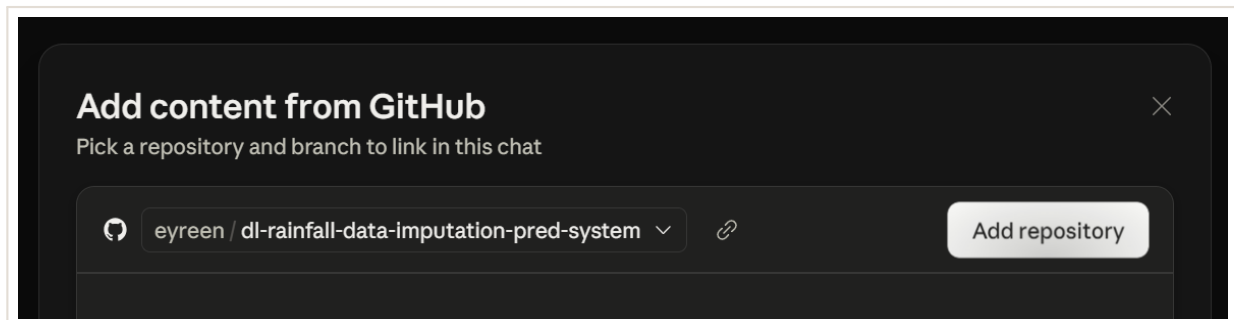


Figure 3 — Confirming the selected repository before adding it.

**Tip** — Use the link icon next to the dropdown if you need to point Claude to a specific branch instead of the default one.

### 4 Start asking questions

After the repository is added, Claude drops its link (for example, **github.com/eyreen/dl-rainfall-data-imputation-pred-system/tree/main**) into the message box. Type your question below it and send — Claude will read the repo and answer based on its actual contents.

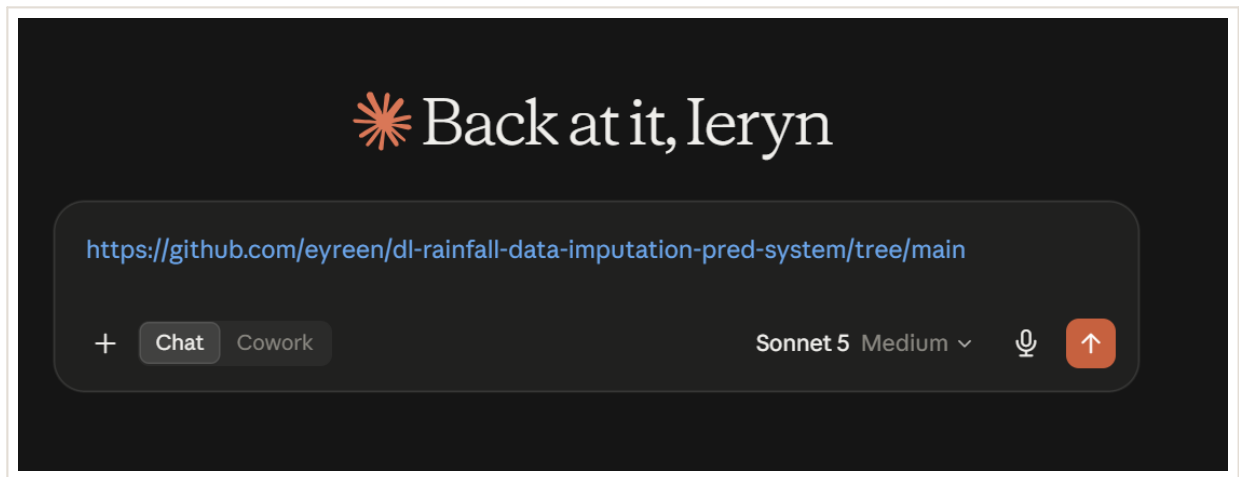


Figure 4 — The linked repository ready in a new chat, with the message box open for your question.

**Tip** — Ask specific questions for the best answers, e.g. “What does the data imputation model in this repo do?” or “Where is the training loop defined?” rather than a generic “explain this repo.”

## Example Questions to Ask Claude

Once a repository is linked, Claude can answer a wide range of questions about it. A few examples to try:

|                                |                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Understand the codebase</b> | "Give me a high-level overview of what this repository does and how the folders are organized." |
| <b>Trace functionality</b>     | "Where is the rainfall imputation model defined, and what algorithm does it use?"               |
| <b>Debug an issue</b>          | "Why might this function be returning NaN values for missing rainfall data?"                    |
| <b>Review before changes</b>   | "What would break if I changed the input shape expected by the prediction script?"              |
| <b>Onboard quickly</b>         | "If I'm new to this repo, which files should I read first to understand the pipeline?"          |

## Troubleshooting

| Issue                                                      | What to check                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Repository doesn't appear in the dropdown                  | Confirm your GitHub account is connected to Claude and that the account has access to the repo. |
| Claude's answers seem out of date                          | Re-add the repository or start a new chat to pull the latest commit on the linked branch.       |
| Need a different branch                                    | Use the link icon in the repository panel to point to the branch you need before adding it.     |
| Need Claude to edit or run code, not just answer questions | Use "Try Claude Code" from the initial prompt instead of GitHub sync alone.                     |

End of guide. For questions beyond this document, consult your team's internal support channel.